

Here are the activity details for **Self-Study Discussion 1.2: Data Strategy [30 minutes]**:

Learning Outcome Addressed

- Analyze an AI-driven product or process to determine how effectively it leverages data strategies to create and sustain a competitive advantage.

(Note: This is a self-study discussion and does not count toward the completion of the program.)

Introduction

As you move into the third stage of the AI design process, you will need to consider how to select the right data strategy. As discussed in Video 1.7, your data strategy will be central to the design of your AI product and to cultivating a sustainable advantage. In this discussion, you will draw on the strategies deployed by some of the most influential American companies to examine the three data-related factors that promote a sustainable advantage:

- Network externalities
 - System lock-in
 - Economies of scale
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Tasks

1. **Find a Media Source:** Find an article, podcast, video, or other media that describes one AI product or process of interest. The product or process you select *must* contain some type of AI integration.
 2. **Describe Sustainable Advantage:** Describe how and how much your selected AI product is designed to attain a sustainable advantage *in at least three of these four areas*:
 - Network externalities (also called “network effects”)
 - System lock-in (also called “switching costs”)
 - Economies of scale
 - Another approach to using data to maximize a sustainable competitive advantage
 3. **Analyze Value Added:** Analyze the value AI has added to the technology from a:
 - Business perspective
 - Customer or user perspective
 4. **Peer Interaction:** Read the statements posted by your peers. Respond to your peers with thoughtful comments and questions to deepen the discussion.
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Submission Instructions

- **Suggested Word Count:** 150–200 words
- **Average Completion Time:** 30 minutes